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Zero tolerance for ‘street takeovers,’ Healey warns

Unclear if incidents at different locales linked

By Shannon Larson, Nick Stoico, and Matt Stout

GLOBE STAFF

Amid anger over a series of “street takeovers” in Boston and several cities and towns in Eastern Massachusetts over the weekend, Governor Maura Healey said the state has “zero tolerance” for the disorderly car events and directed the State Police to assist local law enforcement “to identify, apprehend, and punish offenders.”

Healey warned that participants will be prosecuted.

“If you do it, we’re going to find you and we will hold you accountable to the furthest extent of the law,” she said Wednesday at the State House.

Healey dismissed a question about whether she was concerned that President Trump would consider deploying the National Guard in Massachusetts, as he has done in other Democrat-leaning states and cities.

“He absolutely shouldn’t,” she said. “There’s no need for that here.”

Police Commissioner Michael Cox said it was too early to say whether the street takeovers and similar incidents that unfolded in Boston, Randolph, and other communities Saturday night into Sunday morning were connected.

He said cars and unruly crowds have been descending on intersections across the country for the past few years, fueled largely by social media.

“It’s a trend, a culture trend. It’s getting out of control. It needs to be stopped and it’s very dangerous,” Cox told a Globe reporter at the State

DRIVERS, Page A10

JOAN BENNETT KENNEDY
1936-2025

Away from spotlight, she found peace at last

By Bryan Marquard

GLOBE STAFF

When she gave a graduation address at her alma mater, Manhattanville College, in 1984, Joan Bennett Kennedy cautioned against the temptation to “drift endlessly in a tide of guilt and despair.” She was well-acquainted with those swift emotional currents after her marriage to Senator Edward M. Kennedy ended in divorce a few years earlier.

“I believe we can use our mistakes as building blocks for deeper insight and for change,” she said that day, more than a quarter-century into an exceedingly public existence as the senator’s first wife.

Ms. Kennedy, who drew from her own struggles with addiction and depression as she advocated for mental health efforts, was 89 when she died in her sleep Wednesday in her Boston home, Steve Kerrigan, chair of the state Democratic Party, announced in a statement.

“I will always admire my mother for the way that she faced up to her challenges with grace, courage, humility, and honesty,” her son Ted Kennedy Jr. said as part of that statement. “She taught me how to be more truthful with myself and how careful listen-

KENNEDY, Page C9



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Joan Bennett Kennedy, shown in 2000, was a talented pianist who began playing as a young girl.



EMILIO MORENATTI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Relatives and supporters of the Israeli hostages celebrated in Tel Aviv after the announcement of the agreement early Thursday.

A breakthrough in Mideast

Trump says deal reached for Hamas to release hostages, Israel to pull back in Gaza

By David E. Sanger, Ephrat Livni, and Aaron Boxerman

NEW YORK TIMES

After months of deadlock, Israel and Hamas reached an agreement for the release of Israeli hostages in exchange for Palestinian prisoners, a long-awaited breakthrough that could point toward an end to the two-year war in the Gaza Strip.

President Trump, who helped broker the deal, announced on social media Wednesday night that both sides had agreed to the first phase of his plan, including that Israel would pull back its troops to an

agreed-upon line. Qatar, one of the countries helping the negotiations, and Hamas also indicated in statements that the agreement would allow for the entry of aid into Gaza.

The details of the deal were unclear, including the timing and specifics of the exchange, as well as the line of withdrawal. But one official familiar with the details said the exchange was expected as soon as this weekend.

“This is a GREAT Day for the Arab and Muslim World, Israel, all surrounding Nations, and the United States of America, and we thank the

mediators from Qatar, Egypt, and Turkey, who worked with us to make this Historic and Unprecedented Event happen,” Trump said on Truth Social.

While Israel and Hamas had agreed to an exchange, it was still not clear whether the war in Gaza would end. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel has demanded that Hamas disarm, which the militant group has publicly rejected. Statements on the deal from Hamas, Israel, Trump, and Qatar made no mention of Hamas’s arms. And Israel, in its initial statements,

did not mention a troop pullback.

Netanyahu issued a statement saying he would convene his government on Thursday to sign off on the agreement, calling it a “great day for Israel.”

He thanked Trump but did not provide details.

Hamas in its statement called on Trump, guarantors to the agreement, and others to compel Israel “to fully implement the agreement’s requirements and not allow it to evade or delay.”

In late September, Trump un-

MIDEAST, Page A4

Norfolk sheriff’s expenditures draw questions

Business venture follows purchase of online courses through his taxpayer-funded office

By Matt Stout

GLOBE STAFF

Patrick McDermott, Norfolk County’s elected sheriff, tapped his taxpayer-funded office for thousands of dollars in online courses last year, taking tutorials in how to grow a business, launch a podcast, and craft webinars that can turn a profit.

McDermott has yet to create a digital course or podcast within the Norfolk County Sheriff’s Department. But months after ringing up those charges on his office-issued procurement card, the self-de-

scribed real estate mentor launched something else: an online “game-changing membership” that — for a \$67 monthly or \$670 annual fee — offered advice and coaching to subscribers to help them take their “real estate business to the next level.”

“It’s NOT Just Another Course,” McDermott wrote of his “Off-Market Millionaire Experience” in one of several since-deleted pitches on his personal LinkedIn page or in Facebook posts. “It’s a Complete System.”

McDermott, in an interview and



McDermott quits as head of sheriffs’ association. B1.

would “enhance my leadership skills and improve the [office’s] operations.”

But the confluence of his department’s business-centric spending and the launch of McDermott’s personal venture alarmed good government experts, who said the existence of the real estate workshop raises questions about the ex-

subsequent statement to the Globe, said there was no correlation between his outside interest in real estate and the taxpayer-funded charges, which he said

penditures’ true intent.

McDermott said the “Off-Market Millionaire Experience” has generated “nominal, outside income” for him, and attracted 10 members. He said he meets with them monthly on Zoom and shares knowledge he gleaned from his 18 years as Norfolk County’s register of probate.

“It’s not a business,” he said. “I look at it as a political opportunity to build out my political base.”

McDermott made a similar argument to state campaign finance regulators after they accused him of misusing campaign donations to bolster his “personal business future.”

SHERIFF, Page A10

Financial problems mount for neglected court system

By Sean Cotter

GLOBE STAFF

These days, even a common cold can disrupt the Massachusetts justice system.

It happened just over a week ago, when an assistant court clerk was sick, forcing the short-staffed Suffolk Superior Court to combine two criminal sessions to accommodate a cramped schedule. The clerk for civil courts said he similarly fears a “mad scramble” to staff court proceedings when anyone on his team is out.

“Every day it depends on what our staffing is,” said Maura Hennigan, the clerk-magistrate for criminal business in the Superior Court that covers Boston. “We don’t know how long we’re going to go on like this.”

And the staffing shortage, triggered by a state-imposed hiring freeze, is but

one of several financial problems piling onto the court system, ratcheting up tensions in a part of government that has often felt overlooked by Beacon Hill.

A work stoppage by court-appointed defense attorneys for indigent defendants over higher pay has rippled through the system, resulting in the dismissal of hundreds of cases. The prosecutors on the other side of those cases are also lobbying for higher wages — or leaving outright. And all of this is unfolding in courthouses that are long-overdue for a rebuild, but a \$3 billion improvement plan from 2017 has long since been mostly abandoned.

Court observers say the judicial system has been so neglected by the state government for so long that conditions have reached a visible breaking point.

COURTS, Page A7

Former FBI director James Comey, who has been targeted by President Trump, pleaded not guilty to charges he lied to Congress. A2.

The Massachusetts House voted to restore \$70 million in spending that Governor Maura Healey snipped from the fiscal 2026 budget she signed in July. **B1.**

The 13 people arrested during a pro-Palestinian protest on Boston Common should be prosecuted for allegedly attacking police, Mayor Michelle Wu said. **B1.**

REI Co-Op said it will close its only store in Boston in late 2026, 23 years after it opened in the Fenway. **D1.**

The Bruins kicked off their season with a 3-1 win over the Washington Capitals. **C1.**



Brisk averse

Thursday: Much cooler. High 56-61. Low 40-45.

Friday: Still fallish. High 60-65. Low 45-50.

High tide: 1 a.m., 1:15 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:50 Sunset: 6:12

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

Obituaries, C9.

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